

ANCIENT JEWISH MEDITATION LITERATURE

WEEK 5

BibleProject • Adult Sunday School

THE BIG IDEA

The Bible is designed for slow, repeated reading. Its carefully chosen details and intentional puzzles invite us to let Scripture interpret Scripture.

1 READ IN ITS WORLD

The Bible comes from the ancient Jewish world. Every time and culture produces its own kinds of literature, so we must learn the Bible's literary habits.

2 NOTICE WHAT IS GIVEN

Biblical stories often omit details modern readers expect. That simplicity is deceptive: every detail the author does give matters.

3 FOLLOW THE CLUES

Some ambiguities are intentional. They invite continued reading, careful comparison, and discovery—not careless speculation or imported assumptions.

4 LET THE BIBLE INTERPRET ITSELF

Individual passages become clearer in light of the whole story. Patterns, repeated words, genealogies, prophets, and later books illuminate one another.

A CLUE THAT RUNS THROUGH THE WHOLE STORY

The woman's "offspring" in Genesis 3 becomes a thread to follow: genealogies → David's royal line → Isaiah's suffering servant → Jesus → the woman, her offspring, and the dragon in Revelation. Each part helps interpret the others.

THE PSALM 1 READING RHYTHM

SLOW DOWN → READ ALOUD → PONDER THE PUZZLES → TALK TOGETHER → READ AGAIN

In Hebrew, "meditate" carries the sense of muttering or speaking quietly. Biblical meditation is a lifelong, communal practice of reading and re-reading until the story becomes our story—and the Bible begins to read us.

TAKE-HOME TRUTH

**Read slowly. Read repeatedly. Read together.
Let the Bible interpret itself—and let its story reshape yours.**